



DISCUSSION GUIDE

Lisa Sharon Harper

Four Words that Change Everything

Lisa is a minister, prolific speaker, writer and activist. She is a columnist at Sojourners Magazine and the founder and president of FreedomRoad.us, a consulting organization that creates space for discussion, stories, and community-formation.

REFLECT

1. Lisa describes viewing the gospel (specifically as a message of redemption from sinfulness and future reward in heaven rather than punishment in hell) through the lens of her enslaved ancestor. What present individuals or people groups can you imagine would also not find such a message to mean “good news?” What might actually sound like good news to them?
2. Lisa notes that in ancient times, the only one said to bear the image of the divine was royalty; the Hebrew Bible demonstrates a new and radical change by declaring all humankind as God’s image-bearers. What does this tell you about:
 - The character and personality of such a God?
 - The creativity of such a God?
 - The desire of such a God?

RESPOND

3. Lisa shows us images of violence and exploitation and explicitly states that we crush the image of God and so make war on God and God’s kingdom. Many of these images reflect politically driven events or events with political outcomes. How does your faith community navigate discussing issues that involve political effects on human beings? Where must the church begin if it is to have these conversations and create true impact?
4. Lisa ends by reframing the good news: that God has come to end the oppressive kingdoms of the world. If the church proclaims this good news, what new methods of proclamation might the church use?